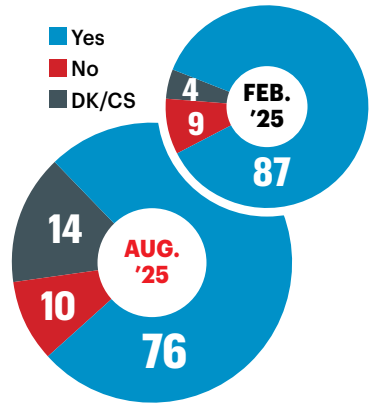
but a steady progression from earlier surveys, suggesting that what once seemed like a worry at the margins is now a mainstream sentiment. And yet, paradoxically, a majority still claims they feel free to express their views on both politics and religion. The contradiction is telling. Indians may continue to exercise their voice in private spaces or local contexts, but there is an unmistakable perception that the larger architecture of democracy—its institutions, its checks and balances—is weakening. The anxiety is less about whether one can speak, and more about whether speaking matters.

Anxieties over Institutions

The survey illuminates growing tensions in India's federal structure. A majority (43.2 per cent) views governors in Opposition-ruled states as politically motivated actors, with another 18.3 per cent partially agreeing. This perception strikes at the heart of constitutional design, where governors theoretically serve as neutral arbiters between a state and the Centre.

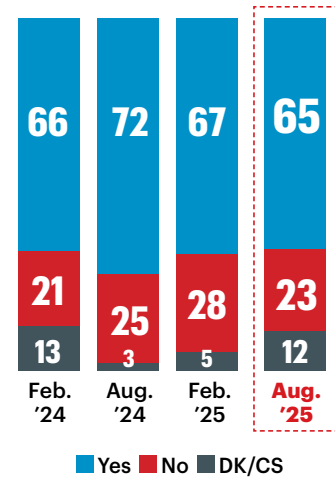
That anxiety is mirrored in perceptions about corruption. When Modi swept to power in 2014, one of his most powerful promises was to rid India of endemic graft. More than a decade later, 45.2 per cent respondents believe his government has reduced graft, but 47.2 per cent disagree. This represents a marked shift from just six months ago, when the government enjoyed a 10-point advantage on this metric. In fact, the share of those affirming government progress on curbing corruption has declined sharply since 2024. In tandem, 45.5 per cent respondents say that the BJP government misuses enforcement agencies like the ED and the CBI more than its predecessors did. This dual slide—in confidence about corruption control and suspicion of political misuse of agencies—marks a dangerous erosion of the very plank that once brought the government to power. It suggests that the aura of being cleaner than the rest, so central to the Modi brand, is under serious strain.

Q. Should the minimum support price (MSP) for agricultural produce be legally guaranteed by the government?



Support for legal guarantee on MSP softens, though still dominant

Q. Do you support the idea of One Nation, One Poll?



Voices in favour of synchronising all elections are still strong

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: Don't know/can't say

69 PER CENT

respondents in the South think it's important to learn and speak the local tongue of the state where you live

Social Crosscurrents

The terrain of identity and culture, meanwhile, shows an electorate deeply divided. When it comes to caste-based reservations, more than a quarter of respondents call them essential for social equality, but an almost equal proportion now believes they should be scrapped entirely. The largest segment sits somewhere in the middle, insisting that the system needs reforms. This middle ground is significant. It reflects neither blind defence nor outright rejection, but a demand for recalibration, proof that the quota debate has entered a new phase where generational and class anxieties intertwine with caste politics.

History and language are equally fraught. An overwhelming 71.9 per cent support revising history textbooks, though they split evenly between those believing history has been 'misrepresented' (36 per cent) and those worried about political motivation (35.9 per cent). This indicates that in an environment where history has become a battlefield of ideological legitimacy, Indians want their past re-examined but fear the process being hijacked for partisan ends.

On language, the response is more pragmatic. A vast majority agrees that learning the local tongue makes life easier, though most resist the idea of it being enforced. It is a reminder that while Indians negotiate multiple identities daily, they prefer choice over coercion.

In an era of digital polarisation, Indians display remarkable unity on one issue: 81.4 per cent support stricter government regulation of social media